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CASE STUDY (VIVINO) & INTRODUCTION TO THE FINAL PROJECT



Identifying Market Inefficiency (The “Why”)

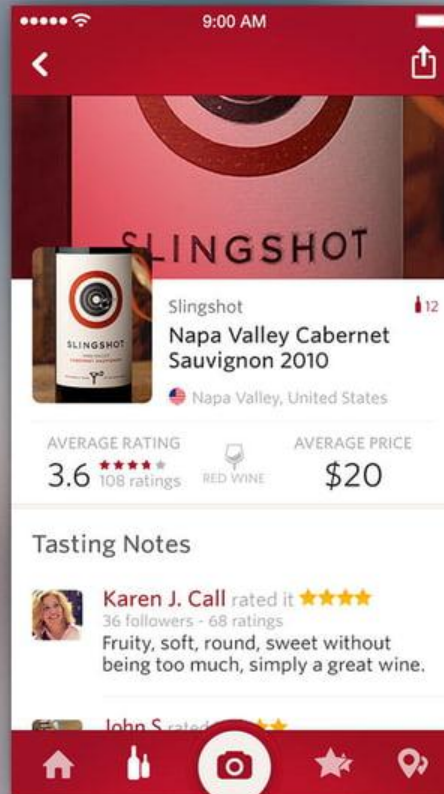
The Core Issue: High Friction & Information Asymmetry

- **Information Asymmetry (The "Expert" Gap)**
 - Wineries and sommelier experts hold the knowledge; the buyer is “in the dark.”
- **High search costs**
 - Hundreds of bottles, zero clarity. Without a system, the cost of finding the "right" wine is too high.
- **Price Opacity (Lack of Transparency)**
 - Prices fluctuate wildly between stores. Without real-time data, consumers can't tell if they are getting a fair deal.
- **Fragmented Data (Siloed Information)**
 - Expert reviews, niche blogs, and store data are scattered and hard to access in real-time.

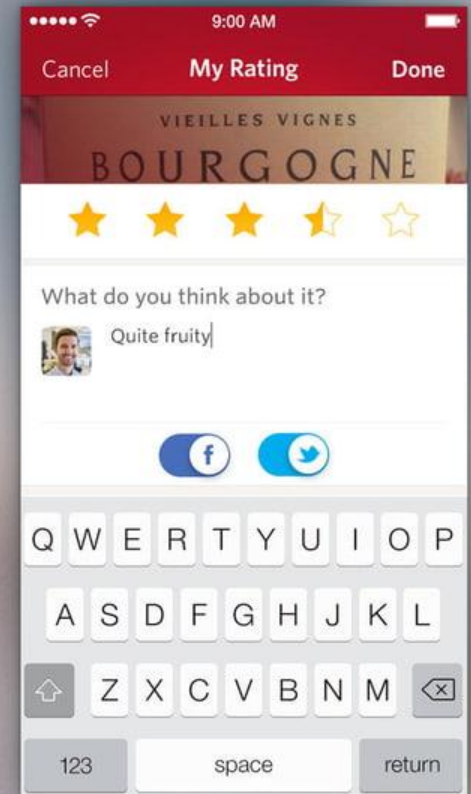
Snap a photo to learn
all about the wine



Find the best wines
in your area



Remember, rate and share
all the wines you taste



Focus: Building a product powered by the people

- **The "Single-Player" Utility**
 - App launched as *a Label Scanner and Personal Wine Diary*.
 - Providing instant decision support (ratings and reviews)
 - Also useful for you to remember what you drank
- **Building the Data Engine (Input → Process → Output)**
 - **Input:** User provide data through crowdsourcing (photos/reviews)
 - **Process:** AI Image Recognition + **The "Manual Hack"** (Humans identifying labels that the AI missed)
 - **Output:** Instant Information (Ratings, Pricing, Reviews)
- **Data Network Effect**
 - More users → More data → Higher Product Value

A massive, crowdsourced database is extremely difficult
for competitors to replicate.

Key data features as of today

- **Wine Label Scanner**

Users can take a photo of any wine label to instantly receive its community rating, average price, and user reviews.

- **Wine List Scanner**

This tool allows users to scan an entire restaurant wine menu to see ratings for every bottle listed, helping them make informed choices while dining out.

- **Taste Profile & "Match for You"**

After a user rates at least five wines, Vivino creates a personalized **Taste Profile**. It then provides a percentage score (70–100%) indicating how likely they are to enjoy a specific bottle based on their past preferences.

- **Food Pairings**

The app suggests ideal wines for specific dishes (e.g., beef, poultry, pasta) based on user tastes and community feedback.

- **Virtual Wine Cellar**

A digital inventory tool where users can track the bottles they own, set "drinking windows" to know when a wine is at its peak, and record personal tasting notes.

Value Creation for Consumers

Empowering the User through Data

- **Instant Decision Support**
 - Immediate access to ratings and price checks while shopping.
- **Trust in "Collective Intelligence"**
 - Shift from elite critics to authentic reviews from millions of users.
- **Price Transparency**
 - Market average data prevents overpaying and ensures "fair value".
- **Industry Democratization**
 - Small wineries gain global visibility without traditional marketing budgets.

Transition to a Multi-Sided Business Model

Phase 1: Consumer-Focused (Initial)

- Free app used to accumulate massive review data.
- (Later) Premium Subscription for personalized recommendations and cellar tools

Phase 2: Multi-Sided Expansion (Monetization)

- **Consumers:** Looking for transparency and buying
- **Retailers:** Using the app to sell wines
- **Wineries:** Looking for consumer data insights and sponsorship opportunities.
- **Advertisers:** Using big data for targeted marketing

What's new?

DINING

Global wine rating app Vivino opening its world's first retail store in Singapore at Raffles City

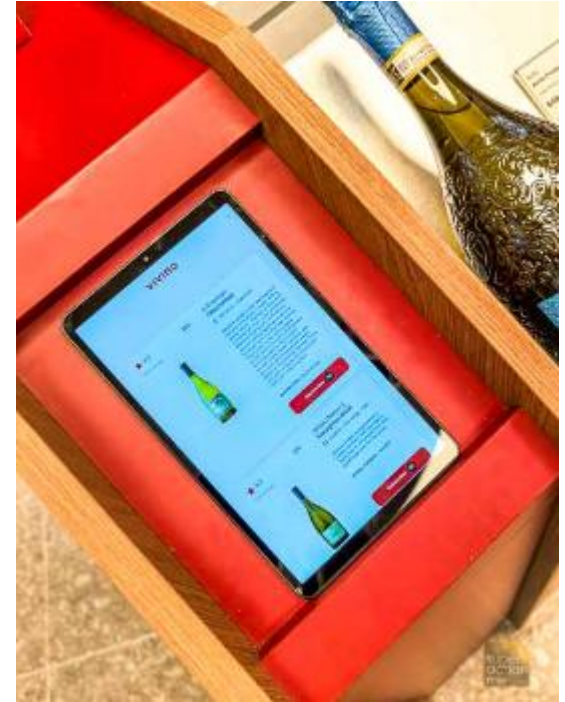
Customers will have access to Vivino's top-rated wines, have the opportunity to purchase wines by the glass at an in-store wine bar, and be able to get recommendations via digital kiosks – great news if you love wine and hate talking to people.



What's new?

*“The over 100 wine labels available at the Vivino Wine Shop will be **curated based on Vivino’s extensive data on Singaporeans’ preferences**, with more than 95 per cent of the wines carrying a Vivino rating of over 4.0. Prices will range from S\$19.90 to S\$555.”*

*“At “Vivino Recommends” kiosks, customers can take interactive wine quizzes that leverage Vivino’s crowdsourced information about the taste profiles of wines. They will receive **personalised recommendations for wines that closely match their palate**, based on Vivino’s extensive database of over 100 million user ratings and reviews.”*



<https://cnalifestyle.channelnewsasia.com/dining/vivino-wine-retail-store-opens-singapore-395596>

Core Business Logic

- **Data Network Effect → Consumer Base → Industry Attraction:**
The data was the magnet that pulled in the supply side (retailers/wineries).
- **Revenue Diversification:**
Moving beyond a single source to a mix of **Transaction Fees + Partnership Fees + Advertising + Subscriptions + Offline shops**

FINAL GROUP PROJECT

- **Objective:** Using the "Vivino Approach," your group will identify a market inefficiency and design an Information System that starts as a useful data tool and evolves into a multi-sided platform.
- We have 71 students in total.
 - 4 groups of 4 students (G1 – G4)
 - 11 groups of 5 students (G5 – G15)

4 Requirements

Part 1: Problem Identification: Market Inefficiency Audit

Identify a market that is currently "broken." You must describe the problem using at least two of the following IS concepts:

- **Information Asymmetry:** Where sellers hold an unfair advantage.
- **Search/Transaction Costs:** Where finding and verifying a product takes too much time or effort.
- **Price Opacity:** Where it is difficult to know the “fair” market price.
- **Fragmented Data:** Where information is trapped in "silos" (analog records, expert heads) and isn't integrated.

4 Requirements

Part 2: The Digital Tool & The Data Engine

Propose a digital app or service that addresses the inefficiencies above.

- **Core Utility Features:**
 - What does the app do on day one? Explain the *initial features* that solve the user's immediate problem.
 - What are the *mature core features* once you have a massive database? (e.g., Vivino's "Taste Profile" or "Best Wine for your Budget" recommendations).
- **Data Network Effect:** Explain your loop: how does more data directly improve these core features and create more value for the next user?
- **Data Collection:** How will you get your data? (Crowdsourcing, manual input, API integrations, etc.)
- **Visualization (*Optional but Recommended*):** Provide a simple sketch of the app's interface (some mature core features).

4 Requirements

Part 3: Sequential Onboarding

(Building the Platform: **at least, 4 sides**)

Explain your strategic order of entry. Do not try to attract everyone at once.

- **Who to attract first?** Explain the value of the tool to this first group.
- **Who to onboard next?** List the subsequent groups to onboard (at least, three more). Who are they?
- **The Value Exchange:** For each group, explain:
 - Why do they want to join? (What value do they get?)
 - What value does their presence add for the *existing* users?

4 Requirements

Part 4: Revenue Model

Describe the app's overall business model.

- **Mix of Revenue Models:** (e.g., Transaction fees, charging for access, advertisement, licensing data, subscription, etc.).
- **Target of Charge:** Clearly state whom you are charging and why that specific group is willing to pay.

A. Individual Performance (5%)

Each member is evaluated on their specific delivery:

- **Clarity & Confidence:** Speak clearly and professionally without over-reliance on notes.
- **Engagement:** Maintain eye contact and engage the audience effectively.
- **Preparation:** Demonstrate a thorough and seamless understanding of your assigned part.

B. Group Content & Q&A (5%)

The group as a whole is evaluated on the following:

- **Visual & Narrative Flow:** How effectively the content is organized and presented.
- **Q&A Ownership:** The ability to respond to questions with clarity, composure, and a deep understanding of the topic. The group must be prepared to defend their analysis and recommendations.
- **Submission:** The presentation slides must be submitted online via Canvas by S23(Apr 27).

3. Final Project Report (15%)

The report is a comprehensive, written elaboration of your presentation. While the presentation introduces your ideas, the report must provide significantly more depth and rigorous analysis.

- **Format:** Up to 12 pages (A4, 1-inch margins, double-spaced, 11pt, Times New Roman). Submit via Canvas.
- **Structure:** Address the assignment questions in a holistic and integrated manner rather than a simple Q&A format.
- **Submission:** The report must be submitted online via Canvas by the due date, May 9.

Evaluation Criteria:

- **Specificity:** Present focused, in-depth insights rather than broad and shallow ideas. Be precise in your analysis.
- **Reasoning:** Provide logical, well-justified arguments to support your strategies.
- **Feasibility:** Ensure your proposed ideas are realistic and implementable.
- **Novelty & Creativity:** Offer innovative solutions, highlighting "killer ideas" that differentiate your strategy.

3. Peer Evaluation & Individual Grade Moderation

While the group project is a collective effort, the final grade for each student is not necessarily identical. To ensure accountability and reward exceptional contribution, I will moderate individual grades based on peer evaluations.

- **The "Merit Bonus":** This system is not just to catch "free-riders." Exceptional contributors who are recognized by their peers for outstanding leadership or taking on significant technical/research burdens may receive an individual score **higher than the base group grade (up to +15-20%)**.
- **Low Performance:** Conversely, students who are identified as "free-riders" or who fail to meet their team obligations will see a **significant reduction** in their final project grade.

Note: Do not take teamwork lightly. Your peers will evaluate your contribution to research, writing, and presentation via a mandatory **Peer & Self-Evaluation** at the end of the semester. The instructor reserves the right to adjust individual grades significantly based on these evaluations to ensure a fair and merit-based grading environment.

Session/Date	Topic
<i>Apr 3 - 8</i>	<i>Mid-term Break</i>
Session 19 <i>Apr 13</i>	<i>Industry Week</i>
Session 20 <i>Apr 15</i>	
Session 21 <i>Apr 20</i>	Emerging Tech – Blockchain and Web3 I
Session 22 <i>Apr 22</i>	Emerging Tech – Blockchain and Web3 II
Session 23 <i>Apr 27</i>	Project Presentations I <u>NOTE: SUBMIT YOUR FINAL GROUP PRESENTATION SLIDES</u>
Session 24 <i>Apr 29</i>	Project Presentations II
Session 25 <i>May 04</i>	Project Presentations III
	Project Presentations IV
Session 26 <i>May 06</i>	Wrap up and Review for Final Exam
	Final Exam <u>NOTE: (LOCATION/DATE: To Be Announced)</u>

		May						
12						1	2	
13	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	
	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	
	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	
	31							

Instead, I will hold a
Zoom session (Q&A)
at night on May 20)

May 22 (in the early morning @ SH Ho Sports Hall)

APPENDIX I Final Group Project Rubric

1. Final Group Presentation Rubric (10%)

Part A: Individual Performance (5%)

Evaluates the specific delivery and professionalism of each student.

Criteria	Exceptional (5)	Proficient (3-4)	Needs Improvement (1-2)
Clarity & Confidence	Speaks clearly and professionally. Maintains steady eye contact and does not rely on notes.	Generally confident but occasionally checks notes or speaks too quickly/quietly.	Relies heavily on reading notes or a script. Little to no audience engagement.
Preparation & Ownership	Demonstrates complete mastery of their part; uses technical terms accurately and seamlessly.	Understands the flow but may stumble on complex explanations or specific details.	Appears unfamiliar with the content; explanations are vague or confusing.

Part B: Group Content & Q&A (5%)

Evaluates the overall narrative flow, visual quality, and the team's defensive ability.

Criteria	Exceptional (5)	Proficient (3-4)	Needs Improvement (1-2)
Visuals & Narrative	Slides are professional and easy to read. Transitions between members are seamless and logical.	Slides are clear but may be text-heavy. Transitions are mostly smooth with minor pauses.	Visuals are cluttered or unprofessional. The presentation feels disjointed or repetitive.
Q&A Performance	Responds with composure and deep insight. Effectively defends analysis with logical evidence.	Answers most questions well, though some responses may lack specific depth.	Unable to address questions effectively; demonstrates a lack of preparation or understanding.

2. Final Project Report Rubric (15%)

Evaluates the depth, logic, and professional rigor of the written document.

Criteria	Exceptional (13-15)	Proficient (9-12)	Developing (5-8)
Depth & Specificity	Provides rigorous, in-depth analysis using course frameworks. Avoids broad generalizations.	Good analysis included, but some sections remain descriptive rather than analytical.	Analysis is shallow; fails to go significantly deeper than the presentation slides.
Reasoning & Logic	Arguments are highly persuasive and backed by strong, logical evidence.	Logical flow is sound, but some claims lack specific supporting data.	Arguments are fragmented; the connection between analysis and strategy is weak.
Feasibility & Novelty	Offers highly realistic solutions with original "Killer Ideas" that differentiate the strategy.	Solutions are realistic but lack a unique or innovative edge.	Ideas are either impractical/unrealistic or lack any original creative thought.
Professionalism	Perfectly adheres to formatting (A4, double-spaced, 11pt). Excellent business writing.	Adheres to most formatting rules; minor typos or layout inconsistencies present.	Fails to follow formatting guidelines; report is unorganized or unprofessional.

Note that individual project grades may be adjusted (+/-) based on the mandatory peer evaluation results to ensure accountability.

Appendix II Peer and Self-Evaluation Form

Objective: This evaluation is designed to ensure accountability and fairness in the final group project. Your honest feedback is critical for the instructor to moderate individual grades based on actual contribution.

Confidentiality: This form will be seen **only** by the instructor. Your ratings and comments will not be shared with your teammates.

I. Individual Ratings

Rate yourself and each team member on a scale of **1 to 5** (5=Excellent, 4=Good, 3=Average, 2=Below Average, 1=Poor).

Name	Reliability & Punctuality	Quality of Contribution	Collaboration & Spirit	Overall Score
1. (Self)				
2.				
3.				
4.				
5.				

- **Reliability:** Met deadlines, attended group meetings, and was reachable.
- **Quality:** Provided substantive research, analysis, or technical work that improved the project.
- **Collaboration:** Listened to others, shared ideas, and helped resolve conflicts.

II. Relative Contribution (%)

If your group's total effort equals 100%, how would you distribute that percentage among all members? **The total must sum to 100%.**

- **Self:** _____ %
- **Member 2:** _____ %
- **Member 3:** _____ %
- **Member 4:** _____ %
- **Member 5:** _____ %
- **Total:** 100%

III. Qualitative Reflection (Confidential)

1. Self-Reflection: Briefly describe your specific role and primary contributions to the project (e.g., specific sections of the report you wrote, data you analyzed, or presentation slides you designed).

2. Peer Feedback: If you assigned a score of **2 or lower** or **5** to any member, please provide a brief justification here. (Examples: "Always late to meetings," "Took the lead in complex data analysis," etc.)